

Wireshark

- Graphical User Interface (GUI)
- Higher resource consumption due to GUI rendering
- Uses Wireshark Display Filters (and capture filters)
- Deep Packet Inspection (DPI), stream reconstruction

Similarities

- Open-Source & Cross-Platform
- Packet Capture File Format Compatibility (`.pcap` / `.pcapng`)
- Filtering Capabilities
- Network protocol analyzer

tcpdump

- Command-Line Interface (CLI)
- Very low CPU & memory footprint
- Uses Berkeley Packet Filters (BPF) syntax
- Quick inspection, light packet header analysis